Rizal's Life Abroad





In Spain (1882-1885)

SECRET MISSION IN SPAIN

- To observe keenly, the life and culture, languages and customs, industries and commerce, and government and laws of the European nations. In order to prepare himself in the mighty task of liberating his oppressed people from Spanish tyranny.





Spain in Barcelona

RIZAL IN BARCELONA

- ***May 3, 1882*** - Rizal departed on board the Spanish Steamer Salvadora bound for Singapore. Rizal's departure for Spain was kept secret to avoid detection by the Spanish authorities and friars.

- ***June 16, 1882*** - Rizal finally reached his destination— Barcelona.







ARTICLES WRITTEN BY RIZAL

- ***Amor Patrio*** *(Love of country) - A nationalistic essay written by Rizal under his pen name "Laong Laan" which urged his compatriots to love their fatherland, the Philippines.*

- *Other written articles of Rizal:* ***Los Viajes*** *(Travels),* ***Revista de Madrid*** *(Review of Madrid) - this one was returned to him because the Diariong Tagalog has ceased publication due to lack of funds.*





Spain in Madrid

RIZAL IN MADRID

- ***November 3, 1882*** - *Rizal enrolled in Unibersidad Central de Madrid in two courses: Medicine and Philosophy and Letters. Rizal led a Spartan life in Madrid.*

- *He also studied Painting and Sculpture in Academy of Fine Arts and took lesson in French, German and English.*





CIRCULO HISPANO-FILIPINO

(Hispano-Philippine Circle)

- Shortly after his arrival, Rizal joined a ***Circulo Hispano-Filipino*** (Hispano-Philippine Circle) – a society of Spaniards and Filipinos.

- ***"They Ask Me For Verses"*** (Me Piden Versos) – a poem written by Rizal in response to the request of the members of the society. It is a sad poem in which Rizal poured out the cry of his agonizing heart.





RIZAL AS LOVER OF BOOKS

- Beecher Stowe's uncle Tom's Cabin and Eugene Sue's The Washington Jew - aroused the sympathy of Rizal to his oppressed and unfortunate people

RIZAL AS A MASON

- **March 1883** - Rizal joined the Masonic Lodge Acacia in Madrid under his masonic name "Dimasalang." Rizal's reasons of being a mason:

The bad friars in the Philippines, by their abuses unworthy of their priestly habit or calling, drove Rizal to desperation and Masonry.

He needed the help of the Masons to fight the bad friars in the Philippines, for Masonry, to Rizal, was a shield to use in his fight against the evil forces of the tyranny.





Paris in France

RIZAL IN PARIS

- ***June 17, 1883*** - Rizal sojourn in Paris. He stayed at a cheaper hotel on 124 Rue de Rennes in the Latin quarter.
- Like all tourists, Rizal was attracted by the beautiful sights of Paris. He visited important landmark like the Place de la Concorde, Arch of Triumph, the Cathedral of Notre Dame and others.
- He spent his hours in museum, botanical garden and art galleries. According to Rizal, "Paris is the costliest capital in Europe."







- Two hospitals where Rizal made some observation:

1. **Laennec hospital** - where Rizal observed Dr. Nicaise treating his patient.
2. **Lariboisiere hospital** - where Rizal observed the examination of different diseases of women.

- **August 20, 1883** - He returned to Madrid and continues with his studies.

RIZAL'S SALUTE TO LUNA AND HIDALGO

In the evening of **June 25, 1884**, a banquet was sponsored by the Filipino community to celebrate the double victory of the Filipino artists in the National Exposition of Fine Art in Madrid. Luna's Spolarium winning the first prize and Hidalgo's Christian Virgins Exposed to the populace second prize. Rizal was also the guest speaker.





STUDIES COMPLETED IN SPAIN

- **June 21, 1884** - conferred the degree of Licentiate in Medicine. He was not awarded his Doctor's diploma due to the fact that he did not present the thesis required for graduation nor paid the corresponding fees.
- **June 19, 1885** - Licentiate in Philosophy and Letters with a rating of "Excellent"

CONTINUED STAY IN EUROPE (1885-1887)

- Rizal went to Paris and Germany in order to specialize in Ophthalmology. He travelled and observed European life and customs in Paris, Heidelberg, Leipzig and Berlin.





PARIS (1885-1886)

- He was 24 years old and already a physician. He went to Paris to obtain knowledge in Ophthalmology. In **November 1885**, he worked for four months as an assistant to Dr. Louis de Weckert, a leading French ophthalmologist.

- Outside of his working hours, he also found time to relax and be with his good friends like Pardo de Taveras, Juan Luna and Felix Resurreccion Hidalgo. At the studio of Juan Luna, he improved his painting technique. He became a model to Juan Luna's several paintings. In the home of Pardo de Taveras, Rizal played the flute, he admitted that he had no natural aptitude for music.







Germany In Heidelberg

- **In February 1886,** Rizal left Paris and went to Germany. He arrived in Heidelberg, a historic city in Germany famous for it old universities and romantic surrounding.
- He lived near the University of Heidelberg and work as an assistant to Dr. Otto Becker at the University Eye Hospital.
- **April 22, 1886** - Rizal wrote a touching poem entitled "To the Flowers of Heidelberg."







Germany In Wilhelmsfeld

- A mountainous village near Heidelberg where Rizal spent his summer vacation.
- Rizal lived with the family of Pastor Karl Ullmer, a Protestant pastor who became his good friend and admirer. The pleasant personality and talents in languages and sketching endeared him to the Ullmer's family.
- For three months he enjoyed the hospitality and kindness of the family.
- **June 25, 1886,** he returned to Heidelberg







FIRST LETTER TO BLUMENTRITT

- **July 31, 1886** Rizal wrote his first letter in German to Professor Ferdinand Blumentritt, Director of the Ateneo of Leitmeritz, Austria. Rizal wrote to him after learning that this ethnologist was interested in the Tagalog language. He sent him a book entitled Arithmetica. Published in 2 languages- Spanish and Tagalog. By UST Press of 1868. Author was Rufino Baltazar Hernandez a native of Santa Cruz, Laguna. Ferdinand reciprocated the thoughtful gesture of Rizal by sending him two books. The exchanged marked the beginning of their long and beautiful friendship.



Germany in Leipzig

- In **August 1886**, Rizal arrived in Leipzig. He stayed here for two months doing a lot of writing and translating.
- He very much liked what he saw, the magnificent buildings, wide and clean streets and amiable people.
- William Tell- written by Schiller, Rizal translated it from German into Tagalog so that Filipino might know the story of the champion of Swiss independence.





- ***Hans Andersen's Fairy Tales*** - Rizal also translated this in Tagalog for his nephews and nieces.
- He attended some lectures on history and psychology at the University of Leipzig and met **Professor Friedrich Ratzel** - a famous German historian and Dr. Hans Meyer-German anthropologist. They had become his friends.
- Because of his knowledge of German, Spanish, and other European languages, Rizal worked as proof-reader in a publishing firm.





Germany in Berlin

- In **November 1886**, Rizal arrived in Berlin. He was enchanted by this city because of its scientific atmosphere and the absence of racial prejudice
- **Dr. Feodor Jagor** - Rizal met for the first time this celebrated German scientist-traveler and author of Travels in the Philippines, a book which Rizal read and admired during his student days in Manila.
- **Dr. Rudolf Virchow** - a famous German anthropologist. (Dr. Jagor, introduced Rizal to Dr. Virchow)









- **Dr. Ernest Schweigger (1830-1905)** - famous German ophthalmologist where Rizal worked
- Rizal became a member of the Anthropological Society, the Ethnological Society and the Geographical Society of Berlin, upon the recommendation of Dr. Jagor and Dr. Meyer
- **Tagalische Verkunst** (Tagalog Metrical Art)- Rizal wrote this scholarly paper in German which he read before the society in April 1887. This paper was published bythe society in the same year, and elicited favorable comments from all scientific quarters



GERMAN WOMEN AND THEIR CUSTOMS

- Rizal wrote a letters addressed to his sister, Trinidad. He said that German woman is serious, diligent, educated, and friendly. She is not gossipy, frivolous and quarrelsome.
- Aside from women, Rizal admired the German customs. The Christmas custom of the German delighted him most of his yuletide custom he wrote on Christmas eve. Another interesting German custom observed by Rizal is self-introduction to strangers in a social gathering.

NOLI ME TANGERE PUBLISHED IN BERLIN (1887)



- **March 21, 1887-** the Noli Me Tangere came off the press. The title Noli Me Tangere is a Latin phrase which means "Touch Me Not". "Noli Me Tangere, are words taken from the Gospel of St. John(Chapter 20 Verses 13 to 17).
- Rizal dedicated his **Noli Me Tangere** to the Philippines—**"To My Fatherland"**. It contains 63 chapters and an epilogue. Maximo Viola-The savior of Noli, he gave him the needed funds to publish the novel.







GRAND TOUR FROM GERMANY TO ITALY

- ***May 11, 1887-*** *Rizal and Viola left Berlin by train going to Dresden, one of the best cities in Germany*
- ***May 13- 16, 1887-*** *Rizal and Viola went to Leitmeritz, Bohemia to visit Professor Blumentritt. A kind-hearted, old Austrian professor who became a dear friend of Rizal.*
- *With Prof. Blumentritt as their guide, Rizal and Viola visited the churches, there silence of the Bishop and other important buildings of the city.*
- *From* ***May 20-30, 1887*** *-They visited other cities in Europe like, Prague, Vienna-the "Queen of Danube", Lintz, Rheinfall, Munich and Nuremberg. They visited museums, magnificent buildings, cathedrals and beautiful sights.*





- **June 2 to 3, 1887-** stayed at Schaffhausen, Switzerland· GENEVA- This Swiss city is one of the most beautiful cities in Europe, visited by world tourists every year·
- **June 19, 1887-** Rizal treated Viola to ablow-out· It was his 26th birthday· Rizal and Viola spent fifteen delightful days in Geneva·
- **June 23, 1887-** Viola and Rizal parted ways—Viola returned to Barcelona while Rizal continued the tour to Italy
- **June 27, 1887-** Rizal reached Rome, the "Eternal City" and also called the "City of the Caesars· After a week of wonderful sojourn in Rome, Rizal prepared to return to the Philippines·



First return to the Philippines 1887-1888

TRAVEL TO THE PHILIPPINES

The stunning beauty of the European lands did not stop Rizal from continuously adoring his native land. After the Noli Me Tangere was published, he decided to return to Calamba despite the many warning he received from friends and relatives alike.

- **He had four reasons for returning to the Philippines:**

a) To perform an operation on Dona Teodora's eyes;

b) To defend his oppressed countrymen more effectively than doing so in a foreign land;

c) To find out how his Noli was received by the Filipinos and Spaniards; and

d) To know the reason for Leonor Rivera's long silence







- **July 3, 1887**, Rizal left Marseilles (France), it was his first return to the Philippines after leaving it to study in Spain five years ago.
- **August 6, 1887**, he arrived in Manila and visited some friends.

AT HIS HOMETOWN

- **August 8, 1887**, he reached Calamba. He opened a medical clinic and restored his mother's vision. Such "miraculous" news spread throughout the community like wildfire, thus, his clinic was flocked by people aspiring for a better eyesight. Newly arrived from Germany, he began to be known as " Doctor Uliman" (from the word Aleman) and soon he acquired a lucrative medical practice. He earned $900 from his services as physician.







- Rizal opened a gymnasium for young folks, where he introduced European sports to discourage his town mates from idleness and gambling.
- He also took part in Calamba's civic affairs and on his spare time made paintings of the towns landscapes and translated the German poems of Von Wildernath into Tagalog.
- His happy days at Calamba was marred with the death of his older sister, Olimpia, and to see Leonor Rivera. His family begged him not to see her at her hometown in Camiling because of increasing concerns about his safety. Also Leonor's mother objected to their relationship.



THE CONTROVERSY OVER THE NOLI

- Copies of the Noli Me Tangere had arrived at the Philippines weeks before Rizal's return to the Philippines. Some of copies of his book fell into the hands of the Spaniards especially the friars. They found the novel "heretical, impious, and scandalous in the religious order and anti-patriotic, subversive of public order, injurious to the government of Spain and its function in the Philippine Islands in the political order"



- The controversy over the novel had reached the office of Governor General Emilio Terrero. He requested Rizal to come to Malacañang Palace. Rizal met Governor General Emilio Terrero who informed him of the charges against him. As a defense, Rizal told Terrero that Noli only expose reality.





Not having read the book yet and out of curiosity, the governor general asked for a copy of the controversial novel, which he later confessed that he enjoyed reading. He saw no problem on the book, yet to protect Rizal's life which was then in danger, he assigned Jose Taviel de Andrade, a young Spanish lieutenant, as Rizal's personal bodyguard. The friars asked Governor General Terrero to deport him, but the latter refused because there was no valid charge against Rizal in court.

While still in Calamba, Rizal was seen as a troublemaker. There are groundless tales circulated by his enemies that he was "a German spy, an agent of Bismarck, a Protestant, a Mason, a witch, a soul beyond salvation, etc." Realizing that his family's and friend's safety were risked; and that his fight against the Spaniards have better chance of winning if he'd stay abroad, Rizal, six months after, finally decided to sail back to Europe. His plan was to return to Europe via Hong Kong, Macao, Japan and the United States



Travels in Asia (Hong Kong, Macao and Japan) and the U.S.

FIRST TRIP TO HONG KONG AND MACAO

- On **February 3, 1888**, with a heavy heart, Rizal left Manila for Hong Kong. His powerful enemies refused to give him peace and quiet. Anonymous letters with threat son his life were sent to his parents' house in Calamba.
- On **February 8, 1888-** Rizal arrived in Hong Kong and he was welcomed by Filipino residents.
- Jose Sainz de Varranda, Terrero's former secretary, followed Rizal in the said British colony, and was believed to be commissioned by the Spanish authorities to spy on the hero





- While in Hong Kong, Rizal engaged in cultural activities. Among the experiences while he observed were:

a) The Chinese way of celebrating their New Year, which included making noise and exploding firecrackers to drive away evil spirits;

b) Chinese lauriat parties, where they served many different types of dishes

c) Chinese theatres which used symbolisms and noisy music to entertain an equally noise audience;

d) He also managed to visit different churches and cemeteries that were owned by Catholics, Protestants, and Muslims.





On **February 18-21, 1888**, Rizal also visited Macau, a Portuguese colony near Hong Kong. He was invited to stay at the residence of Don Juan Francisco Lecaros, who was a former Filipino delegate to the Spanish Cortes. For two days, Rizal enjoyed being a tourist and visited different cultural places which included churches, botanical gardens, theaters and the Macao Casino.



- **February 22, 1888-** Rizal left Hong Kong, his destination was Japan.



In Japan

- **February 28, 1888-** Rizal arrived in Yokohama, the next day he went to Tokyo and stayed at Tokyo Hotel for six days.
- Shortly after his arrival, Juan Perez Caballero-secretary of the Spanish Legation, visited Rizal at his hotel who latter invited him to live at the Spanish Legation. Rizal being an intelligent man, realized that the Spanish diplomatic authorities were instructed from Manila to keep track of his activities.

Since it was economical to stay at the legation and he believed that he had nothing to hide, he accepted it.

- **March 7, 1888-** Rizal checked out of Tokyo Hotel and lived at the Spanish Legation







- Rizal was impressed by the scenic Japan and had keenly observed the life, customs, and culture of the people. The things which favorably impressed Rizal in Japan were: the beauty of the country; the cleanliness, politeness, and industry of the Japanese people; the picturesque dress and simple charm of the Japanese women; there were very few thieves in Japan; beggars were rarely seen in the city, streets, unlike in Manila and other cities.
- **April 13, 1888**, Rizal left Japan and boarded the Belgic, bound for the United States.





Rizal's visit to the United States (April- May 1888)

- **April 28, 1888**, Rizal arrived in San Francisco, California. The ship was held under quarantine by the American health authorities, reasoning that there was a cholera epidemic in the Far East where their ship come from. Rizal and other first class passenger of the ship were released from quarantine and allowed to land after seven days.
- On **May 4, 1888**, Rizal arrived in San Francisco and registered at the Palace Hotel and stayed for two days. May 6, 1888, he was in Oakland, he boarded the train for his grand transcontinental trip to the American continent.







- He was able to see places such as Sacramento, Reno, (Nevada), Colorado, Nebraska, Chicago, Albany and on May 13 he reached New York. He stayed in this city for three days, he visited the scenic and historic places.

RIZAL'S IMPRESSIONS OF AMERICA

- **Good impressions**

a)the material progress of the country as shown in the great cities, huge farms, flourishing industries and busy factories;

b)the drive and energy of the American People

c)the natural beauty of the land

d)the high standard of living;





e)the opportunities for better life offered to poor immigrants·

- **Bad impression**

a)the lack of racial equality: "America is the land par excellence of freedom but only for the whites"

- **May 16, 1888-** Rizal left New York for Liverpool, England·

Reformist works in Europe (1889-1981)

IN LONDON

- **May 25, 1888** to **mid-March 1889** - Rizal decided to stay in London because he could improve his English, study and do an annotation of Antonio Morga's Sucecos delas Islas Filipinas and perceived it was a place for him to carry on the reforms he wanted for the Philippines·







ANNOTATING MORGA'S BOOK

May 1888-March 1889 - He spent ten months (10) in the reading room of the British Museum deeply immersed in his historical studies in London. This was the greatest achievement of Rizal in London, the annotating of Morga's book, Sucesos delas Islas Filipinas (Historical Events of the Philippine Islands), which was published in Mexico, 1609.

RIZAL AND THE LA SOLIDARIDAD

During his stay in London, Rizal also made used of his time in writing essays and articles for La Solidaridad. He also wrote La Vision del Fray Rodriguez (The Vision of FrayRodriguez)-pamphlet which published in Barcelona under his nom-de-plume Dimas Alang in order to defense his novel.





It was mid-March 1899, Rizal decided to move to Paris. He noticed that Parisian life was different from the life he experienced in London. It was a city bursting with merriment, exciting events, and unending social gathering. The cost of living was also very high.

IN PARIS

- Rizal never lost his focus although life in Paris was gay, he continued to spend long hours at the National library in Paris. There, he went on reviewing and rewriting his historical annotations on De Morga's Sucesos de las Islas Filipinas. It was published on January 1890. He also wrote a satirical booklet entitled Por Telefono, in answer to Fr. Salvation Fort, a Spanish friar who hurled attacks on the Noli Me Tangere and caused its banning





- He continued his study on various languages especially the French language, which he was able to perfect during his 10 months stay at the French capital city.
- He organized a social club called Kidlat Club , a social club which brought together young Filipinos residing in Paris. Soon, the members of the said club founded a new Filipino society - the Indios Bravos, an organization which envisioned Filipinos being recognized by Spain for being excellent in various fields of knowledge
- In between his more serious activities, Rizal also had leisurely activities like socializing with friends in their homes. Among those he frequently visited were the homes of the Pardo de Taveras, the Venturas, the Lunas, the Bousteads and others.



- Although Rizal lived a frugal life, he prepared a sumptuous Christmas dinner for some of his friends. Shortly after New Year, he visited London for the last time

IN BRUSSELS

- **January 28, 1890**, left Paris for Brussels. He left the extravagant and gay social life in Paris and stayed in a boarding house owned by the Jacoby sisters in Brussels.

- **From 1889-1890**, Rizal continued contributing for La Solidaridad under the pseudonyms Dimas Alang and Laong Laan. Among the 10 articles he had contributed below were some of the most famous and important articles:



a) The Philippines Within a Century-article written by Rizal which he expressed his views on the Spanish colonization in the Philippines.

b) The Indolence of the Filipinos- It is an able defence of the alleged indolence of the Filipinos.

c) The Sobre la Nueva Ortografia de la Lengua Tagala (The New Orthography of the Tagalog Language) In this article, he laid down the rules of the new Tagalog orthography

- From Calamba, Rizal received letters telling that the agrarian trouble in the province was getting worse, and as such, he decided to go home.



- But instead of going home, a letter from Paciano told him that they already lost the case against the Dominicans and they were in need of a lawyer who would defend their family and the families in Calamba from Madrid.

- Rizal wrote a letter to Ponce, he announced that he was leaving Brussels and decided to go to Madrid because this case must be presented to the Supreme Court and he needs to pay close attention to the developments of the case.





MISFORTUNES IN MADRID (1890-1891)

- **August 1890**, Rizal arrived in Madrid. Upon arrival in Madrid. Rizal immediately sought help of the Filipino colony, The Asociacion Hispano-Filipina, and the liberal Spanish newspaper in securing justice for the oppressed Calamba tenants. Nothing came out of this, several newspapers were sympathetic to the plight of the Calamba tenants but this did not translate to any form of action. By this time, Francisco Rizal and other tenants were already forcibly evicted from Calamba by Governor General Valeriano Weyler. Their houses were burned and more people were exiled regardless of their gender.







- **December 1890**, Rizal received a letter from Leonor Rivera announcing her coming marriage to Henry Kipping, an Englishman (the choice of her mother)·This was a big blow for him and his heart broke·

- Another marked event in Madrid was the Marcelo H· del Pilar-Jose Rizal rivalry for leadership in the Asociacion Hispano Filipino· A fraction emerged from the Filipinos in Madrid, the Rizalistas and Pilaristas· The group decided that the leader must be elected by two-thirds vote· Rizal won the election, he was offered the appointment but he did not want to see the Filipinos in Madrid divided so he thought it best to leave the city·





- Rizal took a vacation in the resort city of Biarritz on the fabulous French Riviera. He was a guest of the rich Boustead family at its winter residence—Villa Eliada. The one month vacation in this city worked wonders for Rizal. This is where he was able to finish his second novel El Filibusterismo.

- **March 30, 1891**, Rizal bade farewell to the hospitable and friendly Bousteads and proceeded to Paris by Train. He stayed at the home of his friend Valentin Ventura.



RETIREMENT FROM THE PROPAGANDA MOVEMENT

- **April 1891**, Rizal was back to Brussels where he became busy revising and polishing the manuscript of El Filibusterismo.
- Rizal retired from the Propaganda Movement. He notified the Propaganda authorities in Manila to cancel his monthly allowance and devote the money to some better cause, such as the education of a young Filipino student in Europe. He desired to publish his second novel, to practice his medical profession, and later when he became financially independent, he expected to make a more vigorous campaign for his country's redemption.
- Simultaneously with his retirement from the Propaganda Movement, Rizal ceased writing articles for La Solidaridad. Many of his friends in Spain urged him to continue his writing because his articles always attracted considerable attention in European Countries.

- M·H· Del Pilar himself realized the need for Rizal's collaboration in both the Propaganda Movement and in the La Solidaridad newspaper because the enthusiasm for the reform crusade was declining· He wrote to Rizal begging for forgiveness for any resentment and requesting him to resume writing for the La Solidaridad·
- Rizal replied to Del Pilar's letter, he wrote denying any resentment and explaining why he stopped writing· Below are reasons why Rizal stopped writing for La Solidaridad:

a) Rizal need to work on his book

b) He wanted other Filipinos to work also;

c) Rizal considered it very important to the party that there be unity in the work ;

d) Marcelo H· Del Pilar is already at the top and Rizal also have his own ideas it is better to leave del Pilar alone to direct the policy·

THE PRINTING OF THE EL FILIBUSTERISMO

- ***July 5, 1891*** - Rizal left Brussels for Ghent, a famous university city in Belgium because the cost of printing in Ghent was cheaper than in Brussels. F. Meyer-Van LooPress-a printing shop that give Rizal the lowest quotation for the publication of his novel.

- ***August 6, 1891*** - the printing of his book had to be suspended because Rizal couldno longer give the necessary funds to the printer. Valentin Ventura- the savior of the Fili, when he learned of Rizal's predicament he sent him the necessary funds

- ***September 18, 1891*** - El Filibusterismo came off the press. Rizal gratefully donated the original manuscript and an autographed printed copy to Valentin Ventura





BACK IN HONGKONG

- **On October 18, 1891**, after the Fili' was published, Rizal left Europe. Aboard the S.S Melbourne, he sailed to Hongkong where he lived for seven months. His reasons for venturing to Hongkong were the following:

a) To leave his rivalry with del Pilar

b) To facilitate a Propaganda Movement in Hongkong; and

c) To be proximate to his family in the Philippines



- **On November 20, 1891**, Rizal arrived in Hongkong and was cordially welcomed by the Filipino residents in the city, particularly, his friend Jose Ma. Basa





- December 1, 1891- Rizal wrote his parents asking their permission to returnhome. Rizal had a continued correspondence with his family in Calamba and had been aware of the unsettled agrarian problem. On the same date, his brother-in-law, ManuelT. Hidalgo, sent him a letter relating the sad news of the "deportation of twenty-five persons from Calamba, including father, Neneng, Sisa, Lucia, Paciano and the rest of us."

FAMILY REUNION IN HONG KONG

- **The Christmas of 1891** in Hong Kong was one of the happiest Yuletide celebrations in Rizal's life, he had a happy family reunion.





- While in Hongkong, Rizal practiced his medical career. With the help of his friend, Dr. Lorenzo P. Marquez, they built a large clientele and opened a medical clinic where he was recognized as an excellent eye surgeon. He was equally supported and aided both morally and financially by his family and friends with his chosen career.
- Another marked event during Rizal's stay in Hongkong was his plan to move the landless Filipino to Borneo and transform the said wilderness into a "New Calamba" through the so-called Borneo Colonization Project.
- **In April 1802**, he visited Borneo and negotiated with the British authorities who are willing to provide 100,000 acres of land for the Filipinos. Many Filipino patriots found this project amusing, thus, promoted the said project. However, there were a number who objected it, one of which was Rizal's brother-in-law, Hidalgo.





- Twice did Rizal wrote a letter addressed to Governor General Eulogio Despujol informing his Borneo colonization project, with whom he received no response. Instead, Despujol commanded the Spanish consul-general in Hongkong to notify Rizal that such project was very unpatriotic, and by immigrating Filipinos to Borneo, the Philippines will surely be lacking of laborers.
- Despite the many oppositions from friends and relatives, he decided to return to Manila on the following reasons:

a) To discuss with Governor General Despujol his Borneo colonization project;



b) To form the La Liga Filipina in the Philippines; and

c) To prove that Eduardo de Lete's allegations on him and his family in Calamba were wrong.

- Before his departure, he wrote three more letters- the first addressed to his parents and friends; the second one, to Filipinos; and the last Governor General Eulogio Despujol.
- Instead of having the protection he desired, Rizal and his sister, Lucia fell into the Spanish trap - a case was secretly filed against Rizal, and Despujol ordered his secretary, Luis de la Torre, to verify whether the patriot had neutralized himself as German citizen or not. And so, the siblings sailed across the China Sea without prior knowledge of what awaits them in the Philippines.

Thank You

